OCTOBER 26, 2026

Higher education is formalizing AI literacy as a degree pathway

This week's strongest signal is structural: schools and universities are moving from ad hoc AI use to formal pathways for assessment, governance, and workforce-ready skills.

Listen · 4:59

1 *Top story*

US · HIGHER EDUCATION

AI majors are scaling from pilot to mainstream

A new WBUR report shows US universities rapidly scaling undergraduate AI majors, with Bentley, MIT, Northeastern, and WPI all expanding programs as institutions compete on AI-ready graduate outcomes. WBUR.

The shift matters beyond higher-ed branding: it signals that AI literacy is becoming a core academic track tied to employability, ethics, and cross-disciplinary training rather than an optional add-on.

> *AI education is moving from elective exposure to formal credentialed pathways.*

Research & evidence

Australia urges schools to follow learning science, not AI hype

AERO's latest guidance says AI can support planning and workload, but warns against outsourcing essential student thinking and calls for clearer assessment expectations. The Educator.

Global higher-ed study maps practical AI governance steps

A D2L/WCET/Opened Culture action guide based on leaders across six continents argues institutions should extend existing policy structures rather than start governance from scratch. PR Newswire.

Vietnam classrooms are validating understanding through process evidence

Teachers report stronger assessment reliability when students submit draft stages, critique AI output, and explain reasoning orally. Vietnam News.

Nordic focus

NORWAY Bodø's AI Academy participation keeps Norway focused on teacher competence, critical model use, and privacy-aware classroom practice. NRK.

ICELAND Iceland's education ministry says AI-assisted teaching-material workflows are under consideration, with final funding allocations still undecided. Iceland Review.

FINLAND Sanoma Learning launched Sanna, a curriculum-aligned AI teacher assistant piloted with more than 1,500 educators across Europe. Yahoo Finance.

DENMARK Denmark's upper-secondary model requiring oral defense of written work remains a leading Nordic response to AI-assisted cheating risk. The Guardian.

Around the globe

🇺🇸 US K-12 governance is widening student participation as Day of AI's Students First Tour scales local policy engagement nationwide. Government Technology.

🇦🇺 AUSTRALIA National guidance is pushing schools to evaluate AI through cognitive outcomes and long-term retention, not short-term efficiency alone. The Educator.

🇨🇳 CHINA AI teaching platforms from Zhejiang Normal University have now been piloted in 50+ schools, including simulation tools for pre-service teacher training. China Daily.

🇬🇭 GHANA The University of Ghana has rolled out 96,000 Gemini for Education licenses with explicit training, integrity, and data-protection requirements. Ghana News Agency.

🇶🇦 QATAR Artefact and HEC Paris Doha launched executive AI capability programmes aimed at ministers and senior institutional leaders across MENA. The Peninsula.

🇸🇬 SINGAPORE EDUtech Asia 2026 is framing the regional agenda around "human-centred, AI-powered" implementation across K-12 and higher education. Yahoo Finance.

Tools & platforms

AI assistants are being redesigned for classroom fit

Education-specific products are emphasizing curriculum alignment, teacher control, and regional compliance rather than generic output

generation.

Yahoo Finance

Governance tooling is becoming operational, not aspirational

Higher-ed leaders are adopting practical governance templates, decision logs, and role-based ownership to move faster with fewer policy gaps.

PR Newswire

Assessment support is shifting to process visibility

The highest-value classroom AI workflows now expose revision and reasoning pathways so teachers can evaluate understanding, not just answers.

Vietnam News

Worth watching

AI majors may become a new admissions differentiator

Universities are likely to market formal AI pathways as a core employability signal.

Student-in-policy models could spread beyond early adopters

Districts may increasingly require youth input in acceptable-use and academic-integrity frameworks.

Assessment redesign will keep accelerating

Process-based evidence systems are moving faster than curriculum overhaul in most regions.

AI in Education Digest · Berit Herstad · October 26, 2026 · Compiled from public sources

Download PDF